

footer information, slide numbering, dates, colour schemes, slide and / or text animations, and backgrounds.

In general, placeholders are only indicative, that is, users can change the contents of the placeholders, reformat the text, etc. to suit their requirements when working with the presentation in Normal view. However, every new slide will by default contain the formatting and other information as specified in the slide master. Text, pictures (such as logos), and other objects that are directly added to the slide master are not editable in Normal view.

There are some minor differences between PowerPoint versions 2003 and 2007 with respect to the contents of placeholders in slide masters. In PowerPoint 2003, when working on the presentations in Normal view, footers are treated like other non-selectable, non-editable text or pictures directly added to the master. In PowerPoint 2007, in Normal view, you may override the default format specified for the footer.

In both PowerPoint 2003 and PowerPoint 2007, you can have multiple masters for each presentation. Thus, one can apply one master to one set of slides, another master to another set of slides, and so on. However, to minimise confusion, it is best to keep the number of masters small.

Customised masters may be saved as part of the presentation itself, or as a design template (or theme) with its own custom colour schemes and other design layouts. The templates have the extension .POT (or .POTX in PowerPoint 2007), and may be reused—while preserving the design layout and supporting elements.

5.2.1. Slide Master, Title Master, And Layouts

Once you are in the slide master view, you can customise and modify the default design and layout of your slides.

In PowerPoint 2003, slide masters are of two types: the “Slide Master” or the “Title Master”. In PowerPoint 2007, this distinc-